

ADR Identification Basics

Internship Task 1 – Pharmacovigilance | VirtualWorks Lab

Objective

To understand the fundamentals of Adverse Drug Reactions (ADRs), their classification, and the importance of Pharmacovigilance in ensuring patient safety.

What is an ADR?

An Adverse Drug Reaction (ADR) is a harmful, unintended, and unwanted response to a medicine that occurs at normal therapeutic doses.

Types of ADR

Type A: Dose-related and predictable (e.g., bleeding with Warfarin).

Type B: Unpredictable/allergic (e.g., penicillin allergy).

Type C: Chronic due to long-term therapy.

Type D: Delayed effects.

Type E: Withdrawal reactions.

Type F: Failure of therapy.

Pharmacovigilance

Pharmacovigilance is the science of detecting, assessing, understanding, and preventing adverse drug reactions to improve patient safety.

Steps for ADR Identification

1. Collect patient information.
2. Review medical history.
3. Record medications.
4. Identify suspected medicine.
5. Check symptom timeline.
6. Assess causality.
7. Document findings.
8. Report the ADR.

Sample Case Study

Patient: 45-year-old female. Medicine: Paracetamol 500 mg. Symptoms: Skin rash, itching, mild swelling after medication. Assessment: Suspected drug-induced allergic skin reaction. Action: Stop medicine and inform physician.

Conclusion

Early identification, assessment, and reporting of ADRs help improve medicine safety and protect public health.

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